

Angry Birds Star Wars II

Game with new levels, powers, and game mechanics released for Android, IOS and Windows Phone 8
<http://dgit.in/15ouqwt>



Amkette Evo TV winner

The winner of Digit Smarter TV contest is "Neeraj Kumar Chandak" from Bangalore and he wins the Amkette EvoTV

Digit Squad



Kanishk Tiwari

Rooting an Android phone / tablet (in detail)

While 'rooting' is a popular term, not everybody understands what the process involves. Rooting Android is like getting administrator access in Windows. As Android is built over the Linux kernel, every Linux OS has a root access called SU(SuperUser). What SU does is let you access all the system files stored in an Android smartphone. For example: in Windows C:/Windows has all the files required to run Windows OS, and getting admin access means you can manipulate those files to a certain extent. Similarly SU gives you access to view and even edit those files in Android. Without rooting it's only possible to view the system folder but not to view or edit the system files.

ADVANTAGES OF ROOTING AN ANDROID SMARTPHONE

Getting Access to the system core

You'll feel great when you root your phone because you will get complete access to the system core files and you can even edit them. This means you can edit the default settings like bluetooth visibility time, unlock a carrier locked phone, and many other things.

Uninstalling the inbuilt or default apps and save space in your Stock ROM

Some phones come with inbuilt apps which cannot be uninstalled so when you root the phone you can delete unwanted apps with ease. For example: a Samsung phone has a group play app which comes preinstalled and can't be uninstalled by default. Through rooting, you can remove that app.

Install more apps to increase customization levels

Some apps in the Play Store require special root access to increase the level of customization. Apps like Seeder (used to increase the smoothness of the ROM), Pimp My ROM (used to edit ROM styles), SetDNS (used to set dns) are some good examples of the type.

Increasing the internal memory

The internal memory issue is not seen these days as phones come with good amount of

internal memory. There used to be special scripts to change the partition of your memory card to EXT and FAT32 so the EXT partition used to act as the internal memory of the phone which solved the memory problem in phones during those days.

Installing a custom recovery menu in your phone

The normal stock recovery menu has no access to install custom zip package of custom ROMs so there are custom recovery menus like ClockWorkMod, TWRP. These should be the first things you install.

Installing custom scripts

When the phone is rooted, you can install custom scripts like Beats Audio driver, Sony Bravia engine and even scripts to overclock the processor or extend the battery life.

Installing custom ROM

This is the important thing: the reason why many people root their phones to install custom ROMs like CyanogenMod, MIUI, AOSP etc. is because they increase the phone's performance.

PRECAUTIONS TO BE TAKEN BEFORE AND AFTER ROOTING

The first thing is to make sure you find the stock ROM of your phone. The Stock ROM is the ROM/OS which is in your smartphone on day one. The reason to keep the stock ROM is to restore the phone if it's bricked.

Backing up EFS Partition

EFS Partition is the inbuilt partition which you'll find in almost every phone. When you root you actually get access to the EFS Partition which contains your phone's IMEI number, Wi-Fi Mac Address And Bluetooth Mac Address. The reason you should backup this partition is to restore your phone if the flashing process corrupts your phone's system files. Backup this partition and store the files somewhere in the Cloud so you can access them anytime. To easily backup this partition, download the



Essential Android apps

EFSBackup app from the Play Store.

Taking backups and Nandroid backup

There are apps like Titanium Backup, Go Backup which let you backup your contacts, SMS, installed apps, installed apps' data and much more. The reason to use this is when you flash a custom ROM you will need to back these up as they can't be restored once your memory card is erased.

Nandroid Backup is a backup app that saves an entire 'image' of your phone, including app status and data and you can restore a complete ROM with this app.

DISADVANTAGES OF ROOTING

Voiding the warranty of your smartphone

A big thing that you have to keep in mind is that you actually void the warranty of your smartphone at the time you root it but you can deal with this if you have backed up the stock ROM of your phone. Just flash the phone with the Stock ROM and it will unroot the phone and install the stock recovery too.

Chances of Bricking the Phone

A 'Soft' brick can be restored by flashing the phone with the stock ROM. If it's a hard brick then the entire motherboard of the phone will have to be changed.

Chances of introducing a virus in the system

When you flash custom zips or custom packages, there is a chance that you may introduce viruses into your phone that may steal your personal data, cause massive system errors, reduce your smartphone's performance, cripple certain features or other issues. To reduce this risk, make sure you read the complete details about the developer who has made the custom ROM before flashing it to your smartphone.

If you want to join this elite gang of Digit Squad members, drop us an email at editor@thinkdigit.com with "Digit Squad" in the subject line